Competitive Landscape

Payaca, Reonic, and the rest of the UK trade-CRM market

1. Who you're actually up against 📊

Competitor	Position
Payaca	UK-native, the most complete dedicated platform for solar/heat pump/battery/EV installers — CRM, pipeline, **MCS-compliant proposals**, scheduling, invoicing. Your closest direct competitor and the one to benchmark feature-for-feature once demo access works.
Reonic	German-founded (2021), raised **€13M Series A in 2024**, actively expanding into the UK right now — a well-funded continental European player running exactly the playbook you're being asked to run. Treat this as the closest pattern-match for "how does a EU trade-CRM vendor actually break into the UK," not just a threat.
Commusoft	Broader UK trade-CRM (plumbing/heating/electrical), deeply entrenched, exceptional job-costing and multi-location stock management. Not renewables-specific — premium pricing and long onboarding cycles are named weaknesses.
Simpro	Enterprise trade contractors and commercial construction — robust multi-stage estimation, but prohibitive implementation/consulting fees and steep learning curves.
BigChange	Logistics/large-scale field service/civil engineering — excellent vehicle tracking and telematics, but a weak front-end sales pipeline and no integrated consumer digital contract workflow.
Jobber / ServiceM8	Small-to-medium micro trade businesses (1–5 vans) — low-cost, intuitive, but lacks enterprise architecture and multi-tier localisation.
Tradify, AdminBase	General trade job-management/CRM tools — compete on price/simplicity rather than renewables-specific depth.

Two of these — Payaca and Reonic — are the ones that actually matter for positioning. Neither appeared in earlier internal planning material; they're the sharpest, most relevant competitive threats and the two worth tracking closely.

2. Where RRUP's actual differentiation could sit ⚠️ (thesis — needs demo verification)

Based on published capability alone, three areas look like plausible wedges once verified against the live demo and against what Payaca/Reonic actually ship:

1. **Cross-vertical breadth in one system.** RRUP already covers solar, heat pumps, AC/refrigeration, construction, service, HRV, and IT — a UK installer who does solar *and* heat pumps *and* battery storage (increasingly the norm) may prefer one system over stitching together single-vertical tools.

2. **Depth of workflow automation.** The Work-Flow engine (auto-tasking, SMS/notification cascades, auto commission calculation) is a specific, named capability — confirm whether Payaca/Reonic match it before claiming it as a differentiator.
3. **Price-to-depth ratio.** RRUP's Polish pricing, even marked up 30–50% for the UK market, likely still undercuts UK-native competitors — a real, usable wedge for price-sensitive smaller installers, the segment growing fastest per the MCS data.

This is a thesis to pressure-test, not a settled USP — it needs the demo and a genuine Payaca/Reonic feature comparison to become a claim you can put in front of a prospect.

3. Objection-handling positioning worth keeping ✅ (strategy, not fabricated fact)

"System of Engagement" vs. "System of Record." For any Tier-2/3 contractor already running SAP, Xero, Sage, or QuickBooks for core accounting, don't position SalesOps CRM as a replacement — position it as an agile front-end that sits on top of their existing system of record via API, handling the vertical-specific calculations (solar array layout, heat pump flow rates/COP, BTU sizing) that would cost tens of thousands in custom development to bolt onto a generic ERP. This is a legitimate, well-worn enterprise-software sales pattern and directly defuses the biggest objection a finance-literate prospect raises ("why would I add another system").

4. What this tells you, honestly

The UK renewables-installer CRM niche is already being actively contested by at least one well-funded EU entrant (Reonic) and one UK-native leader (Payaca). This is not a blue ocean. It's a real, validated, fast-growing category with room for a third credible player — but only with genuine differentiation, not "we're cheaper" or "we're new" alone.